

ZERO TO AI & FREELANCE HERO

Student Curriculum

A 3-week, fully online cohort covering AI prompting, automation, freelancing, and building your first app or website — with two instructors and small-group attention.

DURATION SESSIONS FORMAT

3 Weeks**9 Total****Online, Live**

What You'll Learn, Week by Week

3 live sessions per week · 2 hours per session · assignments between classes

WEEK 1 AI Foundations & Freelancing Groundwork

SESSION 1 · 2 HOURS

Understanding AI: LLMs, AI Agents, and the Tool Landscape

What an LLM actually is, how it differs from an AI agent, and a guided tour of the tools you'll use throughout the cohort.

- What a Large Language Model is and how it generates responses — in plain, non-technical terms.
- The real difference between "AI," an "LLM," and an "AI agent" — and why that distinction changes which tool you reach for.
- Live walkthrough of ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude, and Canva — what each is genuinely best at, not just what's popular.
- How to choose the right tool for a task instead of defaulting to whichever app you know.

Deliverable: A personal "which tool for which task" reference sheet you build during class.

SESSION 2 · 2 HOURS

Prompting That Actually Works

Core prompting technique for accurate, useful results — with hands-on practice across the tools introduced in Session 1.

- Why vague prompts produce vague answers, and the structure that fixes it: context, task, format, constraints.
- Iterative prompting — refining a response step by step instead of accepting the first output.
- Common prompting mistakes beginners make, and how to self-correct them.
- Live practice: each student runs the same real task through two different tools and compares results.

Deliverable: A set of 5 reusable prompt templates for your own work or business.

SESSION 3 · 2 HOURS

The Freelance Landscape

Where freelance income actually comes from: marketplace categories, going rates, and how to identify where your existing skills fit.

- A tour of the major freelance categories — writing, translation/interpretation, design, virtual assistance, and more — and what each actually pays.
- How to read a marketplace listing and estimate realistic going rates for your skill level.
- Self-assessment: mapping your existing skills (including ones you don't think of as "marketable") to a category.
- Why most beginners underprice themselves, and how to avoid it from day one.

Deliverable: Your personal freelance category and target rate range, decided in class.

SESSION 4 · 2 HOURS**Building a Profile That Gets Noticed**

Hands-on profile-building on major freelance platforms, with a focused walkthrough of language-services visibility on Proz.com.

- What makes a freelance profile get clicked versus scrolled past — headline, portfolio samples, and positioning.
- Setting up profiles on two major freelance platforms, live, during class.
- Deep dive into Proz.com for language-services students: language pairs, specialization tags, and how direct client contact actually happens once a profile is strong.
- Using AI tools from Week 1 to draft and refine your profile copy.

Deliverable: Two live, published freelance profiles.

SESSION 5 · 2 HOURS**Automation for Everyday Work**

Chaining AI tools together to automate repetitive tasks — so you're working smarter, not just faster.

- What "automation" actually means at a beginner level — no coding required.
- Identifying repetitive tasks in your own work or business worth automating.
- Chaining two or more AI tools together to handle a multi-step task with minimal manual input.
- Practical examples: auto-drafting client replies, generating repeat reports, and templated content generation.

Deliverable: One working automation you can reuse immediately after the cohort.

SESSION 6 · 2 HOURS**Client Outreach & Your First Clients**

Writing proposals that get replies, and a practical plan for landing your first 2 clients before the cohort ends.

- Anatomy of a proposal that gets a reply versus one that gets ignored.
- Where to find your first real leads on the platforms you set up in Session 4.
- Pricing your first few jobs — when to discount for portfolio-building and when to hold your rate.
- Live proposal-writing practice with instructor feedback in real time.

Deliverable: 3 sent proposals to real job listings by end of session.

SESSION 7 · 2 HOURS**From Idea to Interface**

Introduction to AI-aided app/website builders — no coding background required — and picking the right platform for your idea.

- How AI-aided "vibe coding" platforms work at a conceptual level — you describe, the AI builds.
- Live comparison of leading platforms (e.g. Replit, Lovable) and when to use each.
- Turning a rough business idea into a clear, buildable description the AI can act on.
- Setting up your first project and generating an initial working version.

Deliverable: A live project set up and running, ready to build on in Session 8.

SESSION 8 · 2 HOURS**Build Your First Prototype**

Live build session: turn a sample business idea into a working website or app prototype by directing the AI, layer by layer.

- Explaining a site or app layer by layer to the AI — structure first, then styling, then functionality.
- Iterating on generated output: what to do when the AI gets something wrong.
- Adding real content, images, and basic interactivity to the prototype.
- Troubleshooting common beginner sticking points as they come up, live.

Deliverable: A working website or app prototype, built by you, ready to show.

SESSION 9 · 2 HOURS**Final Presentations & Graduation**

Present what you built, get feedback, review your freelance profile and portfolio, and receive your certificate.

- Each student presents their prototype and freelance profile to the group.
- Instructor feedback and suggested next steps for each student individually.
- Review of the freelance outreach plan started in Session 6 — what's working, what to adjust.
- Certificate presentation and guidance on continuing independently after the cohort ends.

Deliverable: Completed portfolio, certificate, and a personal next-90-days action plan.

By Graduation, You Will Have:

- ✓ At least 5 practical, monetizable skills.
- ✓ Complete profiles on 2 major freelance platforms.
- ✓ A clear plan for landing your first 2 clients.
- ✓ A real app or website prototype you built yourself.
- ✓ A working knowledge of AI tools, prompting, and automation you'll use for years, not just this cohort.